

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

GOVERNMENTS IN INDEPENDENT INDIA

MODULE-7

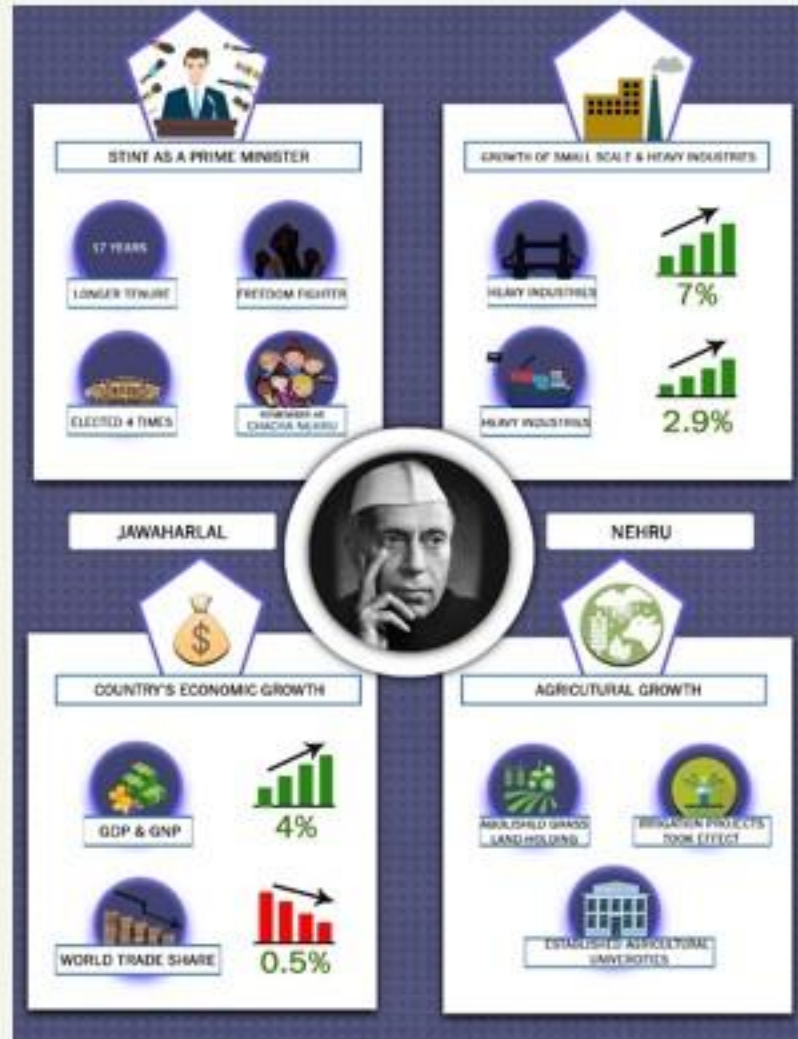


PRIME MINISTER PANDIT JAWAHARLAL NEHRU

(1947-1952 and 1952-1964)

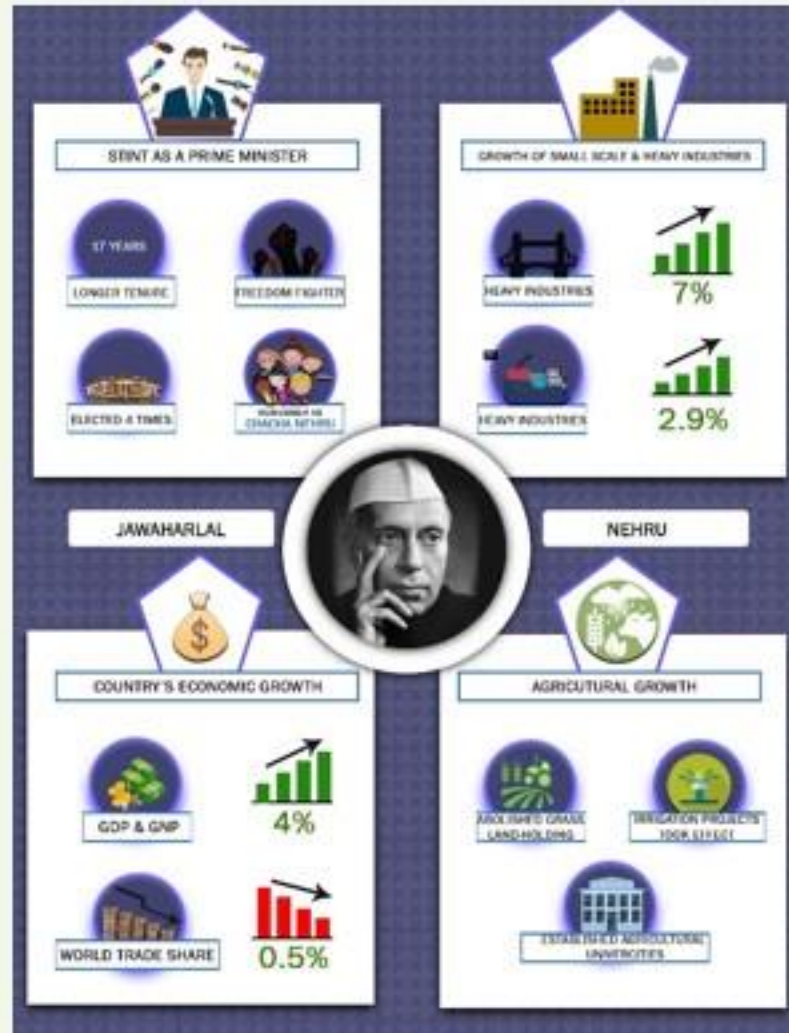


CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- Legacy of leadership to the freedom movement and newly independent India.
- Framing of the Constitution
- Nation Building and territorial integration (as discussed)
- Contributions in the Economic and Social Reform (will be addressed later)
- Foreign Policy (will be discussed later)

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



The greatest contribution of Jawaharlal Nehru, the first Prime Minister of independent India, to the development of the Indian nation was neither the policy of non-alignment nor the conception of the five year plans, but the practical achievement of providing a durable basis to India's democratic institutions and of endowing them with an aura of legitimacy.

There was the organisational legacy, a structure around which men and institutions could function at various levels.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- Institutions like Panchayati Raj have led to a further penetration into society of democratic institutions.
- He helped strengthen the legislative deliberative process in the country. Legislations dealing with labour disputes; laws dealing with property and inheritance rights and removing gross inequalities in the treatment of different classes.

- He provided the framework for the conduction of free and fair elections in the country.
- He ensured that his vision of India was inscribed in the Constitution. He drafted and moved in the Constituent Assembly a resolution that set out its objectives, which included the declaration of India as an independent republic in which all power was derived from the people.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- Nehru's impact on world politics is widely acknowledged.
- He emerged as an authoritative voice and critic of racism, imperialism and an advocate of Asian unity, Afro-Asian solidarity and world peace.
- Nehru was also focused on domestic social change and saw state planning as a driver of growth and an agent for addressing inequality.

Thus the first PM of India, JL Nehru was instrumental in the creation of Modern Indian State.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- PM Nehru was a believer of Science and the positive effects it had on humanity. The West had built up a strong scientific and technological base as a result of the industrial revolution and scientific researches. He wanted to develop a similar scientific temper in the Indian society.

- He was the first non-scientist to preside over the Indian Science Congress on 26 December, 1937.
- In 1939, a National Planning Committee was set up and leading scientists were invited in the formulation of plans for scientific, technological and economic development of the country. India's first national laboratory, the National Physical Laboratory, was laid on 4 January 1947.

Nehru's scientific bent of mind is displayed from the fact that he abhorred religious and traditional practices.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- He was the first non-scientist to preside over the Indian Science Congress on 26 December, 1937.
- In 1939, a National Planning Committee was set up and leading scientists were invited in the formulation of plans for scientific, technological and economic development of the country. India's first national laboratory, the National Physical Laboratory, was laid on 4 January 1947.
- He was supported by people like Homi J Bhabha, Sir C.V. Raman, Satish Dhawan, Nalini Ranjan Sarkar, J.C. Ghosh, Meghnad Saha and S.S. Bhatnagar.
- PM Nehru laid the foundations of Tata Institute of Fundamental Research in 1954.
- Five Indian Institutes of technology (IITs) were established in 1951.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- In the backdrop of warring relations with neighbours, efforts were made to strengthen our defence infrastructure.
- Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) was set up in 1958 for research in the manufacture of missiles, armaments, explosives and other defence-related inventory.
- India was one of the first nations to recognise the importance of nuclear energy. Nehru was convinced that nuclear energy would bring about a global revolution in the social, economic and political spheres, besides affecting a nation's defence capabilities.

- In consultation with Homi J Bhabha, PM Nehru established the Atomic Energy Commission (AEC) and the Department of Atomic Energy on 10 August 1948, even though they understood the disastrous effects of atomic research. The use of atomic energy for peaceful purposes was more important for a country like India whose power resources were limited than an industrially advanced country.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- India also took up space research. It set up the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR) in 1962 and established a Rocket Launching Facility at Thumba (TERLS).
- In 1963, the first rocket was launched.

CONTRIBUTIONS OF PM NEHRU



- Beyond physical infrastructure, PM Nehru was more interested developing a scientific approach and scientific outlook.
- PM Nehru believed that with the spread of education and economic development, scientific temper would slowly get evolved within the Indian society.
- He was thus referred to as the 'maker of Modern India'.

FAILURES OF PM NEHRU

CREATION OF PAKISTAN WITH THE BLOODY PARTITION

JAMMU & KASHMIR

- PM Nehru took the issue of J&K to the UN to get the solution of disputed state as per International law.
- But Maharaja Hari Singh had already accepted the state's integration into India and had signed the Instrument of Accession.
- Once this agreement was signed, the state ceased to be a 'disputed state', even if it was earlier. The people of the state have suffered because of internationalizing the issue.

ARTICLE 370

- PM Nehru has been criticized as he failed to fully integrate the state of J&K and granted the introduction of Article 370 into the constitution.
- It is argued that he should have negotiated well with the stakeholders and handled it diplomatically



FAILURES OF PM NEHRU



- PM Nehru failed to arrive at a diplomatic solution with China.
- Till the 1950s, India remained ignorant of territorial claims by China.
- There was no clarity on border issues and both countries did not discuss the issue.
- PM Nehru underestimated China's ambitions and did not prepare adequately when he was warned about China's intentions.

PRIME MINISTER LAL BAHADUR SHASTRI (1964-1966)



1904 - 1966

- PM Nehru died in May 1964. In two hours, Home minister Gulzarilal Nanda was sworn in as the acting prime minister and the discussions on the second prime minister began.
- K Kamraj and Morarji Desai were some of the contenders.
- The MPs, however, preferred Lal Bahadur Shastri as he was a fine administrator, known as a man of great integrity and competence and had helped PM Nehru in his activities.
- Soon, Lal Bahadur Shastri was sworn in as the second Prime Minister of India.
- Former PM Nehru's daughter Indira Gandhi was given the Information and Broadcasting Ministry.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI



- Lal Bahadur Shastri was a leader of the Indian National Congress and a key figure in the Indian Independence movement.
 - He was deeply influenced by the political teachings of Mahatma Gandhi.
 - He had previously held several portfolios in the Union Cabinet – Minister for Railways; Minister for Transport and Communications; Minister for Commerce and Industry; Home Minister; and during Nehru's illness he was a Minister without portfolio.
-
- When he served as the Minister of Railways and Transport in the Central Cabinet from 1951 to 1956, he offered his resignation in 1956 after a railway accident at Mahbubnagar that led to 112 deaths. However, Nehru did not accept his resignation. Three months later, he resigned accepting moral and constitutional responsibility for a railway accident at Ariyalur in Tamil Nadu that resulted in 144 deaths.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

AGRICULTURE



- PM Shastri increased budget allocations for agriculture and was deeply concerned about the shortage in food production. Imports of food had touched 10 million tonnes.
- With the failure of monsoons, India had suffered a drought situation in 1964 and 1965. Zoning policy of government further affected the situation.
- Trade of food across states was prohibited. The situation in Bihar, most affected by the drought and famine situation, further aggravated non-availability of food.
- PM Shastri appointed C. Subramaniam to head the Ministry of Food and Agriculture.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

DEVELOPMENT OF AGRICULTURE



- C. Subramaniam was born in 1910 in a family of farmers and had practiced law before joining the freedom struggle.
- He was a member of the Constituent Assembly and later joined the Union Cabinet in the Ministry of Agriculture.
- C. Subramaniam reorganized agriculture science, improved the pay and living conditions of scientists. He also encouraged states to establish agricultural universities to focus research on crops of their respective regions.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

DEVELOPMENT OF AGRICULTURE

- He set up a Seed Corporation of India to produce quality seeds in bulk. One of the research included adapting Mexican wheat to Indian conditions.
- Subramaniam asked the United States to provide food aid under PL-480 to Indians till they were able to augment their own production.
- In December 1965, India committed itself to reform the rural credit system and expansion of fertilizer production.
- In return, America provided a series of soft loans and agreed to keep wheat supplies to avoid shortage.
- The Fourth Five Year Plan marked the commitment of the government to introduce green Revolution.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

GREEN REVOLUTION



BACKGROUND

- Food crisis
- Foreign pressure
- Dependency on food aid

OBJECTIVE

- ✓ Increase production rapidly and attain food sufficiency

APPROACH

- ✓ Instead of helping poor farmers, resources were given to areas with existing irrigation infrastructure.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHY WAS PUNJAB CHOSEN?



- Punjab was chosen as the initiation site for Green revolution in India. Punjab is the wheat growing centre of India.
- Following the partition of India by the British, Punjab was split between both the India and Pakistan; with most of the irrigated croplands going to Pakistan along with a majority of India's agricultural research and education facilities.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHY WAS PUNJAB CHOSEN?



- Punjab was chosen for implementing the Green revolution because of its history of agriculture success and continuous water supply.
- Sutlej water from Bhakra was available for use in southern Punjab districts as early as in 1957.
- In 1966, India imported 18,000 tonnes of dwarf wheat seed by ship from Mexico and Punjab was the only state that seized the initiative in transporting its share from the port by road on trucks .

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

GREEN REVOLUTION – STEPS TAKEN



- Government offered High yielding variety seeds, fertilizers, pesticides and irrigation facilities at highly subsidized rates.
- The department of prisons was asked to get prisoners to stitch adequate numbers of cloth bags to distribute seeds to farmers in 10-kg lots.
- The Punjab government picked up most of the fertiliser that was imported via Kandla Port in 1966, anticipating its requirement for the cultivation.
- Other steps taken were introduction of Land reforms, improved rural infrastructure and advanced machinery and supply of agriculture credit.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

GREEN REVOLUTION – OUTCOMES



- Rich peasants and large landholders benefited immensely.
- Rise in Wheat production.
- Overall food availability in the country increased.
- Polarisation between regions-Punjab, Haryana and Western UP flourished.
- Excessive and inappropriate use of fertilizers and pesticides polluted waterways and killed beneficial insects and wild life. The irrigation practices led to soil degradation.

- Heavy dependence on a few crops led to loss of biodiversity of farmers.
- Rise of middle class peasant sections- farmers with medium size land holdings.
- Leftwing organisations capitalized upon the stark difference between Peasants and Landlords.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHITE REVOLUTION - BACKGROUND



- Indian population after independence was largely agrarian and largely dependent on agricultural produce and cattle milk for their livelihood.
- In spite of this dependency, there was the absence of an efficient collection and distribution system for milk. This marginalized the cattle owners and farmers.
- Dr Verghese Kurian, popularly known as the Milkman of India, believed the milk industry helped a marginalized farmer earn cash everyday with a small investment of a purchasing a milch cow.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHITE REVOLUTION - BACKGROUND



- Dr Kurien transformed the country from an importer of dairy products to the world's largest milk producer.
- Under the leadership of PM Shastri, Dr. Kurien set up the National Dairy Development Board and the Kaira District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union Limited (KDCMPUL) or the Amul Dairy Co-operation in 1965.



ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHITE REVOLUTION

Dr. Kurien's White Revolution continues...



- In the 1940s, in the village of Anand in central Gujrat, there was an effort to increase the milk production by producers' cooperative in rural India. The success of the scheme called AMUL later spread to other parts of the country under the name 'Operation Flood'. This came to be known as the White revolution.

- The NDDB, played a significant role in India's White Revolution that was aimed at transforming a hitherto milk-deficient nation into one of the largest milk producers of the world surpassing USA in 1998.
- In 30 years, the milk production per person doubled making dairy farming India's largest self-sustainable rural employment generator. As of 2010-2011, India accounted for 17% of the global output in milk production.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

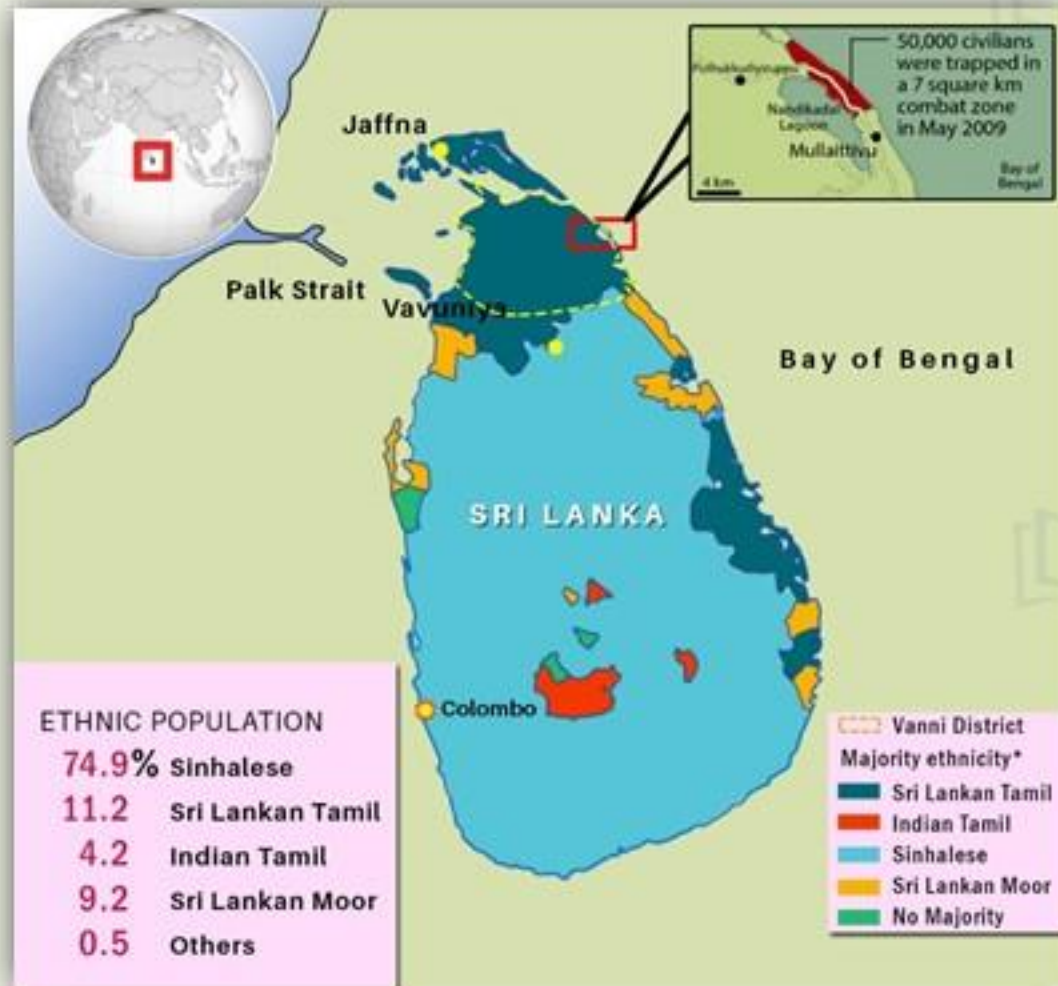
RELATIONS WITH SRI LANKA (CEYLON)



- Like India, Sri Lanka was under British colonial rule. The Colebrook reforms of 1833 had transformed the socio-economic condition in the country. Under this system, Capitalist economy was set up and private sector was encouraged
- Large quantities of unused land were sold to private players and entrepreneurs. The British then authorised the large-scale establishment of commercial plantation leading to the arrival of South-Indian workers.
- They were brought because they were willing to provide labour services for cheap payments, and they were familiar with the cultivation of Tea. The local Sinhalese did not want to work in these plantations.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

WHEN DID THE ISSUE ARISE?



- When Sri Lanka got independence in 1948, the question of citizenship of these plantation workers arose.
- The Citizenship Act of 1949 stripped the legal citizen statuses of the Indian workers.
- To discuss the issue, the Sri Lankan PM Mrs Sirimavo Bandaranaike visited India in 1964 and upon discussions with Indian PM, the Sirima-Shastri pact was signed on 30 October, 1964.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

SIRIMA-SHASTRI PACT



- This pact recognized all people of Indian-origin in Ceylon who weren't citizens of either India or Ceylon; to become citizens of either India or Ceylon.
- The Indian government would accept repatriations of persons within a period of 15 days of the signing of the pact.
- Ceylon agreed to allow those people who were employed during the signing of this pact to continue with their jobs until the date of their repatriation.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

RELATIONS WITH BURMA

Not all countries after independence can sustain a democratic government like India. Burma, our neighbour is one such example.



- Soon after gaining independence and establishing a democratically elected government, political and ethnic tensions started plaguing the country.
- Unable to control the situation, in 1958, the Prime Minister of Burma was forced to accept military rule to restore order. The weaknesses of the democratic government were well exploited by the military government.

ABOUT PM SHASTRI

RELATIONS WITH BURMA



- Under the military rule, many Indians became targets for oppression and discrimination by the people and the government.
- The military General Ne Win ordered the large-scale expulsion of Indians from Burma.
- India monitored all the processes of repatriation and arranged for the identification and transport of Indians from Burma.
- State governments in India were asked to provide adequate facilities for resettlement of these Indians.
- In December 1965, Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri made an official visit to Burma, and re-established cordial relations with the military government in Burma.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588